

Reference - Devika Soren | Ref SYN-16-CJH | Page 1 of 2
ARAFURA FREIGHT LOGISTICS - FICTIONAL COMPANY
27 September 2026
To: Screening Authority
Re: Callum James Hartigan, personal workplace reference
Writer: Devika Soren, warehouse operations manager
Contact: devika.soren@arafurafreight.example.invalid; 08 7000 0xxx

I have supervised Mr Hartigan since he joined Arafura Freight Logistics in August 2022. This letter is my reference based on direct workplace observation. The separate company letter confirms his employment and routine administrative matters. Neither letter purports to assess events at a previous employer where I was not present.

His role requires early starts, checking outbound consignments and allocating tasks to a small adult warehouse team. We have late trucks, incorrect manifests and occasions when drivers want an immediate answer that the floor staff cannot supply. I have seen him remain within the escalation process in those situations. He has called me about a disputed bay instruction rather than continue an argument with a driver.

There have been no disciplinary findings for violence, threats or aggressive conduct at this workplace since his commencement.

That is a checked statement from our personnel record. It is not a claim that he never becomes frustrated. I have spoken with him about keeping handovers concise and avoiding repeated instructions when a new starter needs a practical demonstration. Those were ordinary supervision discussions, not warnings for intimidation.

He is reliable about isolating damaged loads and recording the reason. We had an incorrect pallet count last summer. He initially believed another shift had missed it, then checked the scanner sheet and corrected his own entry. I regard that willingness to correct a mistake as relevant to trust at work. It does not settle a question about a domestic incident several years earlier.

I have read the short descriptions of the conviction, workplace warning and protective order that he supplied when requesting this reference. I am aware that the screening decision concerns children, whereas our staff are adults. I have no direct observation of him alone with a child and no professional qualifications in violence-risk assessment. My recommendation is based on several years of daily work behaviour in a supervised operational setting.

Mr Hartigan's interest in junior coaching predates this application. He arranged leave around a club working bee and spoke about setting up equipment rather than about seeking authority over children. These conversations were ordinary workplace discussions. They are not independent evidence of how every coaching session was run. The club can supply that evidence more directly.

One example from work is useful. In February 2026 two staff disagreed about unloading priority while a vehicle was waiting. Mr Hartigan stopped the unloading movement, put the docket on the desk and asked me to make the priority decision. One employee remained annoyed, but the dispute did not become a shouting match. The record made was an operational delay note. There was no conduct warning arising from it.

The work team includes people with varied experience and English proficiency. He has become better at showing a task rather than assuming one explanation is enough. He can still sound abrupt when there is time pressure. I have told him that, and he has accepted the feedback. I would not write that he has a flawless temperament. I can write that he has followed our directions and responded to ordinary supervision over a sustained period.

For the proposed part-time job, I support an arrangement with a clearly identified supervisor and firm boundaries. That resembles the accountability that works in our warehouse. I understand the Association has its own pending-application arrangement. I do not have authority to grant it or decide whether it is sufficient for clearance. I would tell an employer about a conduct concern if one arose within our workplace and the relevant disclosure process permitted it.

I cannot speak to Jessica Tran's account, her daughter's location on the incident night, or the program's administrative dates. I did not ask either of them for a statement. Those questions should be resolved from appropriate sources. Please treat my letter as evidence of the conduct I have personally observed and the workplace record I checked.

Signed: Devika Soren, 27 September 2026.

Fictional employer and writer; invalid contact details throughout.

This letter contains two pages and no attached clinical opinion.